



Flight & Baggage Claim Starter Guide

Your rights, explained simply, with your first claim
letter ready to send.

FREE GUIDE

TRAVEL HASSLE-FREE

ClaimYourTrip.com

Know Your Rights – Plain English

Which rule helps you depends on where you flew from and which airline you used.

EU261 / UK261 – delays, cancellations, denied boarding

Applies if your flight departed from the EU/UK (any airline), or arrived in the EU/UK on an EU/UK airline. If the disruption was the airline's fault and you arrived 3+ hours late, you may be owed a fixed cash amount.

Flight distance	EU261	UK261
Up to 1,500 km	€250	£220
1,500–3,500 km	€400	£350
Over 3,500 km	€600	£520

Per passenger, not per booking. These amounts are correct as of this edition — rules can change, so always verify with the airline or your national enforcement body.

Baggage – Montreal Convention (worldwide)

Covers delayed, lost, or damaged baggage on most international flights. You can claim your reasonable proven costs up to about **1,519 SDR** per passenger (roughly €1,880 / US\$2,000).

Gulf & MENA flights

If EU/UK law does not apply, your rights come from the airline's own Conditions of Carriage and your local civil aviation authority's complaint route (such as the GCAA in the UAE).

Quick Eligibility Snapshot

Tick the boxes that apply. This is a guide, not a guarantee.

- ☐ Did your flight depart from an EU/UK airport, or arrive in the EU/UK on an EU/UK airline?
- ☐ Did you arrive at your final destination 3+ hours late?
- ☐ Was the cause within the airline's control (not severe weather, ATC strike, security)?

Mostly ticked?

You may be eligible for fixed cash compensation. Use the letter template on the next page to get started.

The 4-step process

- 1 Confirm eligibility
- 2 Save your evidence
- 3 Send your claim
- 4 Follow up after 14 days

Evidence to save

- ☐ Booking confirmation and boarding pass
- ☐ Proof of the actual arrival time (flight tracker screenshot)
- ☐ Any airline email/SMS about the disruption

Your First Claim Letter

Use this for a delayed or cancelled flight. Replace the **[bracketed]** fields with your details, then copy & paste into an email to the airline.

To: Customer Relations, **[Airline Name]**

From: **[Full Name]** | **[Email / Phone]**

Date: **[Date]**

Subject: Compensation claim – Flight **[Flight Number]**, **[Date of Flight]**

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am writing to claim compensation for the delay to flight **[Flight Number]** from **[Departure Airport]** to **[Arrival Airport]** on **[Date of Flight]**, booking reference **[Booking Reference]**.

The flight arrived at its final destination **[Number]** hours late. As the delay was within the airline's control, I believe I am eligible for compensation under **[EU261 / UK261 / applicable rule]**.

Based on the flight distance of approximately **[Distance in km]**, the compensation I am claiming is **[Amount Claimed]** per passenger, for **[Number of Passengers]** passenger(s).

Supporting evidence is attached. Please advise the secure payment method you require, or confirm payment to: **[bank/payment details, if you are comfortable sharing them by email]**.

Yours faithfully,
[Full Name]

Want the complete kit?

This starter guide covers the basics. The full **Complete Flight & Baggage Claim Pack** includes:

- 13 letter templates — delay, cancellation, denied boarding, downgrade, baggage (delayed/lost/damaged), follow-ups, rejection rebuttals, and regulator escalation
- A printable claim tracker
- Full regulator & escalation contact sheet
- Baggage special guide + "airline said no?" rebuttal scripts

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